



- ▶ Describe the pictures. What aspect of technology does each one show? What are the differences between them?
- ▶ Each of these pictures shows a different use for information technology in daily life. What message does each photo give? Is there another way to view it?
- ▶ Do you have strong feelings about any of the technology in these pictures? Which picture fits your own feelings about technology best, and why?

DISCUSSION

How does technology affect the ways we communicate? In what ways is virtual communication (phone, internet, etc.) similar to and different from personal contact?

Have you found online education a good substitution for personal school attendance? What are the upsides and downsides? Do you enjoy online presentations and projects?

Do you participate in online discussions (in discussion groups, on social media, in academic contexts, etc.)? What has your experience been? How can or should online debate be changed?

JUST IMAGINE

You've been asked to lead an online course for children (on any subject you choose). What will you do to make the children feel like a group? What types of activities will you include? What will you try to avoid? What rules will you have for kids who are taking part? What can you do to keep them interested? When you're considering these questions, think about your own experiences of studying online and about the best and most useful learning activities your teachers provided.

DATA MINER

In 2009, **55%** of EU households had internet access at home; in 2019, the figure was **92%**.

The **highest** daily computer use by young people in the EU is found in the Czech Republic, Poland and Slovakia.

Over **25.3%** of the internet is in English, **19.8%** is in Chinese, and **8%** is in Spanish.

Sources: Eurostat, Statista

QUOTES

“The great myth of our times is that technology is communication.”

Libby Larsen
composer

“The technology you use impresses no one. The experience you create with it is everything.”

Sean Garety
web design consultant

“There can be infinite uses of the computer and of new technology, but if the instructors themselves are not able to bring it to the learners and make it work, then it fails.”

Nancy Kassebaum
US senator

WORD BANK

mobile phone (*BrE*)/cell phone (*AmE*) / smartphone / headphones / earbuds / tablet / VR headset / (power / charging / USB / USB-C, etc.) cable / charger / (earbud) charging case / plug / (electric) socket / (HDMI / USB, etc.) port / (headphone/audio) jack / adapter / modem / router / Wi-Fi (network) / charging dock / power bank / battery pack / (micro) SD card / flash drive / (rechargeable) battery / extension cord/cable / multi-plug / the internet of things (IoT) / (to) program / software / hardware / firmware / file / folder / shortcut / (start) menu / taskbar / (to) email / (to) spam / spam filter / start menu / dropdown menu / command line / search function / VPN (virtual private network) / cookies / preferences / permissions / login / password / to debug / to power up / to charge / to pair (Bluetooth devices) / (to) stream / (to) scan / to record / (to) video / to (right-) click on an icon / to back up (data) / (to) update / (to) secure / (to) patch (a vulnerability, etc.) / to hack / to install to surf/browse the web